The Megaphone

ECCO EQUIPMENT CORPORATION

April 24th, 2013 | Volume 8, Issue 2

Moving Dirt to Make Room for Energy

ECCO Equipment is working with Kilgore Pavement and Maintained from Salt Lake City, supplying them with three Cat 631E II Scrapers and one Cat D9R Dozer to move 1.7 million cubic yards of dirt.

Kilgore is extracting the dirt to construct three salt brine retention ponds approximately 3000 feet long and 2500 feet wide. These salt retention ponds will be used to store brine water pumped from underground in order to hollow out salt caverns. The caverns are located one mile underground in a barren patch of desert just outside Delta, UT. Each impermeable cavern will hold the volume of an Empire State building: billions of cubic feet of storage capacity that will store natural gas, liquid petroleum or compressed air for years to come.

Energy storage is catching on as a way to make wind and solar power more useful. Without energy storage, the output of renewable power is erratic; the wind does not always blow and cloud cover can shut down solar cells. Energy storage is key in overcoming intermittent swings in low power production and usage.

ECCO is excited to be a part of this project that could last up to ten years!

Save This Date!

June 2nd, 2013 we will be celebrating our annual ECCO/Marco Company Picnic from 10 a.m. to 4 p.m.! Please come out and join the team with lots of food, fun and festivities! We hope to see you there~!

Safety Dave's Corner

Spring Has Sprung! Here Are Some Helpful Tips To Get You Through The Season **Safely**:

With somewhat warmer weather and longer days approaching, people are focusing on long neglected projects like spring cleaning, home repairs and yard work. Homeowners are ready to clean up items that have accumulated over the winter.

Your medicine cabinet is not meant to be a storage area for all of the medicines that you have ever been prescribed. Spring Cleaning is a good time to get rid of them and any expired over-the-counter medicines that you may have.

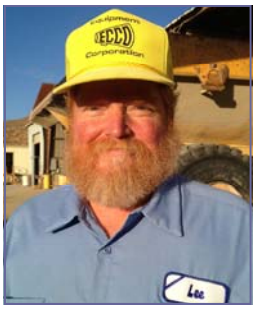
Maintain your yard; trim bushes, plants and trees. Removing vegetation clears fuel for any potential fire. Keep gutters and roofs clear of leaves and other buildup. Check the kids' play area for sharp objects, poisonous plants, and tripping hazards.

Clean-up work areas by putting tools and other work items away. Remove all fire hazards, including stack of rags, newspapers and magazines. Pay attention to spaces around your hot water tanks, fireplaces, space heaters and dryers as well as under stairs.

Check your barbeque grill for leaks and cracks and be sure to store any propane tanks at least 10 feet away from your house and garage. Locate grills a safe distance (at least 10 feet) from buildings or wooden decks.

Test all your smoke alarms to ensure they are working. Change the batteries at least once every year. Most smoke alarms also need "spring cleaning" maintenance-check your manual.

Welcome to the Team



Welcome **Lee Rhodes**! Lee spent 19 years as a mechanic with ECCO before leaving for a brief sabbatical with a local Southern California underground contractor. When the opportunity arose, he was eager to return to his old stomping grounds and resume his career with ECCO. Lee is has been married to his wife, Mary for 26 years and enjoys 4-Wheeling in his spare time. Please feel free to give a shout out to Lee and welcome him home to the ECCO Family.

Say hello to **Sam McCormac**! Sam is our new Sales Rep in Utah. He's 45 years old, has a 27 year old daughter and has been a resident of Utah for 33 years; sales for the last 20. Sam's hobbies include motorcycles and boating and Sam would like us all to know that he is extremely excited to be apart of the ECCO Team!

Curtis Vawdrey is our new mechanic over in Utah! He's married with one child, an 11 month old boy. Curtis enjoys the outdoors, camping and fishing & hiking with his family every chance he gets. He says he loves getting out on the golf course on the weekends as well when he gets free time.

Meet **Aaron Brunko!** Aaron is our new Idaho Mechanic, he's 39 years old and resides in Boise, Idaho. He's married with 4 kids and has spent the last 7 years working as a field service mechanic for N.A. Degerstrom in the mines all over Nevada. In his spare time, Aaron likes to spend time with family, restore old Harley motorcycles, and build "Rat Rods".

The Las Vegas Branch would like to welcome **Justin Kuewa**, their new Dispatcher. Justin has taking on the ever so gruesome task of replacing Sandy Gayhart, who recently moved out of state. He was born in St. George, Utah and raised in Las Vegas. He is married and is the father of two young boys, ages 8 and 11 years. Justin has almost 15 years of experience in the construction industry. The boys keep him busy with their baseball and other athletic schedules; he also coaches. Please join us in welcoming Justin to ECCO.

Quality Time with Larry

By: Tatiana Rodgers

Larry Lozo has been a Top of the Line Mechanic at our Santa Ana/Riverside Branches for 25 years as of May 5th! I'm simply amazed at the amount of time some of our ECCO Veterans have been on the job and I've definitely taken an interest in getting to know them. First things first, I'd just like to say that getting some time with him is almost impossible! Here's what ECCO's Southern California Work Horse had to say when he took some time out of his hectic schedule to sit with me and let me know what 25 years on the job is like:

Q: Wow...25 Years! Do you remember your first day at ECCO?
A: Yes (He Laughs). Ross came, stood in the yard and just watched me work. I let it go for a while, but I finally turned around, looked at him and said, "Do you work here?" It was pretty funny.

Q: How many ECCO Branches have you visited or worked at?
A: 5 Total. Santa Ana, Visalia and Riverside, Las Vegas and San Diego.

Q: What has changed the most in your 25 years?
A: Definitely the technology! Injection pumps, fuel systems, troubleshooting, it has all advanced over the years. No such thing as a dull moment when you're a mechanic!

Q:What's your fondest memory of the good 'ol days?
A: I can remember being busy. Busy Busy Busy...We had at least (40) 450s. They would come in off rent on the lowbeds, we'd change the oil, check them off and send them right back out~! My fondest memory would have to be around lunchtime, every day Les & Don would make it a point to come out, talk with us, hear any concerns we had and just spend time letting us know that we were appreciated.

Q:What the best thing about working for ECCO?
A: I love the family oriented feeling, the environment and the sense of care for the employees. We've worked with some of the best, both inside and outside of ECCO. I appreciate all 25 years, it's been great. And I look forward to 25 more...Thank You!

ECCO Continues To Build

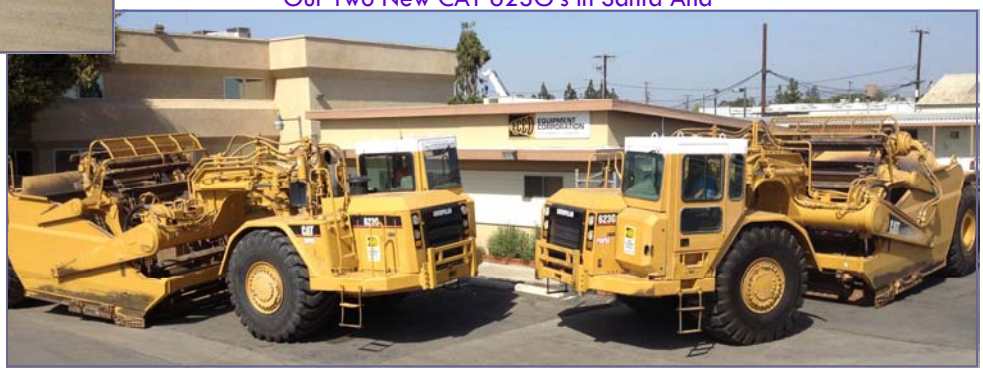
2012 was a busy year for equipment acquisitions and we expect 2013 to be no different as we strive to keep our fleet modern and provide for the needs of our customers. Here are some of the nearly 100 machines we added to the rental fleet since October 2011.

Articulated Trucks	**Dozers**	**Loaders**	**Excavators**	**Excavators (CR, RR)**
2012 Cat 740B	2012 JD 750J LT	2008 Cat 980H	2009 Cat 345D L	2008 Cat 328D LCR
2012 Cat 740B	2012 JD 750J LT	2008 Cat 980H	2007 Cat 345C L	2012 Cat 321D LCR
2012 Cat 740B	2011 Cat D8T	2008 Cat 980H	2009 Cat 336D L	2008 Cat 321D LCR
2008 Cat 740	2007 Cat D8T	2007 Cat 966H	2008 Cat 330D L	2008 Cat 321D LCR
2007 Cat 740	2007 Cat D8T	2007 Cat 966H	2008 Cat 330D L	2009 Cat 320D LRR
2006 Cat 740	2007 Cat D8T	2007 Cat 966H	2008 Cat 330D L	2008 Cat 320D LRR
2005 Volvo A40D	2007 Cat D8T	2006 Cat 966H	2007 Cat 330D L	
2005 Volvo A40D	2006 Cat D8T	2011 Cat 950H	2007 Cat 330D L	**Water Towers**
2005 Volvo A40D	2008 Cat D6T LGP	2008 Cat 950H	2007 Cat 330D L	2013 Klein Water Tower
2005 Volvo A40D	2008 Cat D6T LGP	2007 Cat 950H	2007 Cat 330D L	2013 Klein Water Tower
	2007 Cat D6T LGP	2006 Cat 950H	2006 Cat 330D L	2013 Klein Water Tower
Scrapers	2009 Cat D6T XL	2011 JD 544K	2006 Cat 330D L	2012 Klein Water Tower
2007 Cat 623G	2007 Cat D6T XL	2010 JD 544K	2008 Cat 325D L	2012 Klein Water Tower
2007 Cat 623G	2007 Cat D6T XL		2007 Cat 325D L	2012 Klein Water Tower
	2008 Cat D6N LGP	**Motor Graders**	2007 Cat 325D L	
	2008 Cat D6N LGP	2009 JD 872G	2005 Cat 325C L	
Compaction	2008 Cat D6N LGP	2011 JD 772G	2006 Cat 324D L	**Service Trucks**
2007 Cat 815F II	2008 Cat D6N LGP	2007 JD 772D	2006 Cat 324D L	2013 F750 Svc Truck
2006 Cat CP563E	2008 Cat D6N XL	2008 Cat 140M	2008 Cat 320D L	2013 F750 Svc Truck
2004 Cat CP563E	2007 Cat D6N XL	2008 Cat 140M	2012 JD 200D	2011 F550 Svc Truck

Our Two New CAT 140M's in Visalia

Three New Water Towers in Phoenix

Our Two New CAT 623G's in Santa Ana



Two New JD 750K's in North Dakota

President's Message

April marks my 20th year as an ECCO employee. As I look back over that time, it is surprising how much the company has changed. In early 1993, ECCO did business in just one state (California) and had three locations: Santa Ana, Visalia, and Riverside. (Later in the year we opened the branch in Las Vegas.) About 50% of our business was operated rental. In addition to the more familiar rental items we have today, we rented cranes, side booms, backhoes, Gradalls, Cat 973's and even a Cat 245 shovel. Aside from excavators and dump trucks, almost every piece of equipment was open cab. Oil changes were recorded and updated with pencil and eraser.

Today we rent equipment in two countries and 8 states and provinces and we have 15 branches. Less than 5% of our business is operated rental. We have added roughly 20 categories of rental equipment to the fleet and eliminated 10. Only 3% of the fleet is open cab. Computers track our maintenance.

But despite all the changes, in the ways the matter most, we are the same. We are a family owned company that helps its customers move dirt more economically than they could on their own. We do so in a professional and friendly manner, with emphasis on performance, customer service, and fairness. As the next twenty years progress, we will continue to modernize our fleet and our methods. But our values will remain old fashioned. I have always been proud to work for ECCO and I hope you are too.

David W. Schmid

As a benefit of our agreement with Verizon Wireless, ECCO Employees may be receiving discounts on their personal Verizon Wireless accounts. We would like to ensure that everyone receiving a discount is still eligible to receive this benefit & we would also like to make sure everyone is aware of the opportunity so that they may also be able to take advantage of it. You may be eligible to receive up to 22% off of your phone/bill and up to 25% on accessories.

In the coming months, Verizon Wireless we will be contacting customers who are receiving Employee Discounts under our agreement. In order to confirm eligibility for these discounts, Verizon will ask them to validate their current employment through a simple online process or via postal mail.

All employees will receive detailed instructions on how to validate their employment. If for any reason you do not receive the instructions or you would like to see if you are eligible for a discount, please feel free to contact Tatiana at ECCO Corporate-(714) 554-4851. We appreciate you as an employee and we would like to share with you as many of our rewards as we can!

Second Quarter Anniversaries

April • May • June

Lawrence Lozo Jr.	*Mechanic*	*Riverside*	*25 years*	*Luis Ascencio*	*Laborer*	*Riverside*	*4 years*
Theron Pyle	*Operator*	*Santa Ana*	*21 years*	*Dennis Lloyd*	*Sales Rep.*	*Santa Ana*	*4 years*
David W. Schmid	*President*	*Corporate*	*20 years*	*Richard Pigeon*	*Mechanic*	*Canada*	*2 years*
Terry Angelino	*Mechanic*	*Las Vegas*	*18 years*	*Hal Dahlstrom*	*Sales Rep.*	*San Diego*	*2 years*
Frank Scaduto	*Branch Manager*	*Visalia*	*17 years*	*Ryan Hoffman*	*Mechanic*	*Canada*	*2 years*
Kenneth Miles Jr.	*Vice President*	*Phoenix*	*15 years*	*Robin Weed*	*Mechanic*	*Santa Ana*	*2 years*
Jeff Hightower	*Sales Rep.*	*Phoenix*	*13 years*	*Bradley McManis*	*Mechanic*	*Phoenix*	*1 year*
Scott Chadwick	*Mechanic*	*Stockton*	*11 years*	*Max Stinnett*	*Dispatch*	*Phoenix*	*1 year*
Molly Terry	*Operator*	*Santa Ana*	*9 years*	*Tatiana Rodgers*	*Secretary*	*Corporate*	*1 year*
James Eli	*Sales Rep.*	*Stockton*	*6 years*	*Evan Gronquist*	*Sales Rep.*	*Riverside*	*1 year*